

Chapter 2 Ending Draft + Key Points

Suggested Final Paragraphs for Chapter 2 (Needs Assessment)

Taken together, the literature reviewed in this chapter supports a clear needs assessment for justice-involved emerging adult men in community correctional settings. Emerging adulthood is a distinct developmental period marked by ongoing identity formation, heightened reward sensitivity, emotional instability, and incomplete maturation of self-regulatory capacities, all of which may increase vulnerability to criminal behavior when paired with criminogenic risk factors such as substance misuse, antisocial peer associations, trauma histories, family dysfunction, unemployment, and limited prosocial support. At the same time, the correctional literature consistently demonstrates that punitive or generic approaches are insufficient to meaningfully reduce recidivism, particularly when they fail to account for developmental stage, responsivity needs, and the broader psychosocial context of offending. Thus, the central need identified in this chapter is for a structured, developmentally responsive, and desistance-oriented intervention specifically designed for emerging adult men reentering the community within residential correctional environments such as halfway houses or transitional living programs.

This identified need directly informs the purpose of the present program development dissertation. The proposed intervention is designed to address both risk reduction and strengths development by integrating the Risk-Need-Responsivity model and the Good Lives Model as complementary intervention guides, while drawing on positive psychology and schema therapy to target well-being, maladaptive core beliefs, emotional regulation, motivation, and prosocial identity development. In a community correctional facility, this framework is especially relevant because residents are navigating the critical transition from incarceration to reintegration while facing real-world demands related to housing, employment, relationships, and community adjustment. Accordingly, the needs assessment presented in this chapter establishes the rationale for developing a manualized rehabilitation program for emerging adult men that is theoretically grounded, trauma-informed, and responsive to the developmental and criminogenic factors most closely tied to desistance and reduced recidivism.

Optional Stronger Closing Sentence

Overall, Chapter 2 demonstrates that the problem is not simply that justice-involved emerging adult men reoffend, but that existing systems too often fail to provide developmentally appropriate, theory-driven, and rehabilitative programming capable of supporting lasting desistance during a pivotal stage of adult development.

Key Points This Ending Covers

- Frames Chapter 2 clearly as a **needs assessment**.
- Identifies the target population: **emerging adult men**.
- Identifies the setting: **community correctional / halfway or transitional home**.

- Summarizes the major needs: substance misuse, trauma histories, antisocial peers, family dysfunction, unemployment/instability, weak prosocial support, and identity/self-regulation issues tied to emerging adulthood.
- Explains why current programming is insufficient: too punitive, too generic, not developmentally tailored, and weak responsivity fit.
- Bridges directly to the dissertation purpose: **program development, desistance promotion, recidivism reduction**, use of **RNR + GLM**, and integration of **positive psychology + schema therapy**.

Quick Placement Note

These paragraphs work best at the very end of Chapter 2, after the literature synthesis and immediately before the transition into the next chapter or program description section.